

The Noble King of Vidyā Mantras of the Flying One

Ārya Drāmiḍa Vidyārāja · Toh 610 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་འགྲུ་འཛིན་བའ་རིག་སྒྲུས་ཀྱི་ཐུག་པོ།

Toh 610 in the Kangyur is known in English as The Noble King of Vidyā Mantras of the Flying One, in Sanskrit as Ārya Drāmiḍa Vidyārāja, and in Tibetan as Phakpa Droling Wé Rikngak Kyi Gyelpo. It is a dhāraṇī text — a short canonical scripture concerned with protective mantra practice — specifically addressing the averting of lightning through the propitiation of directional lightning-spirits. The Buddha delivers the teaching at Śrāvastī, instructing Ānanda in a set of formulas said to have been taught by all past fully perfect buddhas, naming the presiding spirits of each cardinal direction and prescribing means for their individual appeasement. As Toh 610 in the Kangyur, it belongs to the broad class of dhāraṇī and vidyā scriptures that form a substantial portion of that collection's protective and ritual literature.

In the language of India: Ārya Drāmiḍa Vidyārāja. In the language of Tibet: The Noble King of Vidyā Mantras of the Flying One.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the courtyard of the bamboo grove. Then the Blessed One spoke to the Venerable Ānanda:

"Ānanda, listen and hold this teaching, which I shall explain just as the fully perfect buddhas of the past have taught it: the averting of all lightning, and the individual appeasement of each direction.

Ānanda, in the eastern direction there is a lightning-spirit called 'One Who Comes.' Ānanda, in the southern direction there is a lightning-spirit called 'Hundred Sounds.' Ānanda, in the western direction there is a lightning-spirit called 'Faded Light.' Ānanda, in the northern direction there is a lightning-spirit called 'Lord of the Stream.'

Ānanda, whoever knows the names of these lightning-spirits and knows in which direction each resides — know that for such a person no fear whatsoever from lightning shall arise. Write down these names of the lightning-spirits, and in whatever places they are set up, no lightning at all shall fall there."

Then, at that time, the Blessed One gave these root secret mantras of the flying one:

Tadyathā: nimi nimi nimi nimi nimi nimi nimindharē — O you who illuminate the three worlds, you who hold the trident, guard me, guard me from all lightning in this direction! svāhā.

And at that very time, the great bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, had assembled in that same gathering and was seated there. He addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, in this presentation of Dharma, I too shall recite these root secret mantras of the flying one:

Tadyathā: hate vihate nihate pratyarthike pratyamitre śuddhe mukte vimale prabhāsvare aṇḍare paṇḍare śvete paṇḍaravāsini harikarade paṅgilākṣi dantimukhi — Guard me, guard me from all untimely death! By the splendour of the noble Avalokiteśvara, may I never encounter any untimely death! svāhā."

Then Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, joined his palms together, turned toward where the Blessed One was, bowed, and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, in this presentation of Dharma, I too shall recite the words of the dhāraṇī:

Tadyathā: muni muni muni muni reri mati mati sumati mahāmati hāhāhāhā — 'Have no fear, for you are without sin!' —" so Vajrapāṇi declared, and concluded: "dṛḍha svāhā.

Blessed One, as for this protection of mine, which none other can overcome — whoever holds it in their heart, or writes it down: I shall constantly and continually protect them from all dangers, and I shall liberate them from all untimely death."

Then Brahmā, the Lord of the Sahā world, addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, for the benefit of all sentient beings, for their healing, and for the production of their well-being, I too shall recite the root secret mantras of the dhāraṇī in this presentation of Dharma:

Tadyathā: hili mili cili svāhā — brahmasvare svare svāhā — brahmagarbhe puṣpasamṣtare svāhā.

Blessed One, this protection of mine is called Brahmā's Retribution. It utterly protects from all untimely death and thoroughly pacifies all evil."

Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, I too shall recite the root secret mantras of the dhāraṇī in this presentation of Dharma:

Tadyathā: nivarāṇī — bandha bandha mādandhe — mati mati — tiṭi — gauri — gāndhārī — caṇḍālī — mātāṃgi — varalāni — hīnamadhyamadhāraṇī malāni — dalamatte — cakrapākri — śavari śavari svāhā.

Blessed One, this vidyā-mantra of mine is called the Vajra Tongue-Stiller. It liberates from all dangers and fully protects from all untimely death."

Then the four Great Kings — Dhṛtarāṣṭra (Guardian of the East), Virūḍhaka (Noble-Born), Virūpākṣa (Ill-Eyed), and the Great King Vaiśravaṇa — bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, for the healing of the many, for the happiness of the many, and out of compassion for the world, we too shall recite the root secret mantras of the dhāraṇī in this presentation of Dharma:

Tadyathā: puṣpe puṣpe — dharmavarihare — āryapraśaste — nirmukte — maṅgali — stute — stāviste svāhā.

Blessed One, this protection of ours, the four Great Kings, is called Freedom from Fear. It produces fearlessness from all dangers, preserves life, and fully protects from all untimely death."

Then the nāga kings — the nāga king Sāgara, the nāga king Vidyutprabhā, the nāga king Anavatapta, the nāga king Vidyujjihva, and the nāga king Śatārcis — bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, we have a great protection called the Wish-Fulfilling Jewel. It repels all lightning, dispels all untimely death, renders the malevolent harmless, and destroys murderous spirits, sorcery, reanimated corpses, and ill omens. Blessed One, out of compassionate concern — for our release from the realm of nāga rebirth and for the abandonment of our miserliness — please accept this. Why so? Because we nāgas are minds afflicted by miserliness; we are thoroughly bound by miserly minds.

Tadyathā: araje — amare — amṛte — akṣaye — puṇyaparyāpate — sarvapāpaprāśamanāye svāhā — āryapuṇyasopakīye svāhā.

Blessed One, know that for whatever man or woman on whose tongue these root secret mantras are recited, or for one on whom they are written, all dangers from lightning shall be absent. Root poison, fang poison, limb poison, and whatever other poison arising from the members of the body — none of these shall bring that person's time of death. May all become well and happy, free from all fears and harms."

Then the Blessed One said "Excellent!" to Śakra, Brahmā, the world-guardians, and those nāga lords: "Excellent! Good ones, you have entered in for the benefit of the many and the happiness of the many, and you have well spoken the words of the protective mantras for upholding this presentation of Dharma. Excellent! Excellent! Those in the directions who are asleep, intoxicated, or deeply intoxicated shall be protected."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, those monks, Śakra, Brahmā, those world-guardians, those nāga lords, and the world together with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised with approval what the Blessed One had spoken.

The noble king of vidyā-mantras called "Soaring" is complete.

This was translated by the Indian masters Jinamitra and Dānāśīla, together with the great editor-translator the monk Yeshé Dé, revised using the new language conventions, and established in final form.

Translator's Notes

- The title "Ārya Drāmiḍa Vidyārāja" is a Sanskrit transliteration preserved in the Tibetan and is somewhat unusual. The epithet "Drāmiḍa" (possibly a regional or proper name) is obscure and does not have a transparent meaning; the Tibetan rendering "the Flying One" corresponds to "Drāmiḍa" (བྱུང་བའི་འཇིག་རྟེན་), though this Tibetan gloss may itself be a creative rendering of the Sanskrit rather than a literal translation. The text is a dhāraṇī-sūtra concerned with protection from lightning and untimely death. The mantra syllables are rendered in roman transliteration throughout, as is standard for such liturgical material; they are not translated. The phrase "Brahmā's Retribution" (བྱུང་བའི་འཇིག་རྟེན་) is literally "Brahmā's punishment/penalty" and may refer to a specific name for this protective formula within the tradition.

- The four Great Kings are named in the Tibetan by their Tibetan equivalents: Yul-'khor-srung (Dhṛtarāṣṭra), 'Phags-skyes-po (Virūdhaka), Mig-mi-bzang (Virūpākṣa), and rNam-thos-kyi bu (Vaiśravaṇa). Their Sanskrit names are supplied here as standard equivalents.

The phrase rendered "Vajra Tongue-Stiller" is a literal rendering of the Tibetan rdo rje lce 'bebs pa, meaning something that strikes down or silences with vajra-force. This is the name given to Śakra's protective mantra, not a standard canonical title, so it is rendered literally.

The final sentence about those "asleep, intoxicated, or deeply intoxicated" being protected is syntactically terse in the Tibetan; the meaning is that through the power of these mantras, even those in such vulnerable states in the surrounding directions will be guarded.

- The colophon names three figures well-attested in the early ninth-century Tibetan royal translation project: Jinamitra and Dānāśīla as the Indian paṇḍitas, and Yeshé Dé as the Tibetan lo-tsā-ba and chief editor. The phrase rendered "new language conventions" refers to the standardized Tibetan-Sanskrit terminological reform promulgated under royal decree, likely associated with the great lexical revision of that era. The title "Soaring" renders the Tibetan བརྒྱུད་པའི་ཐུགས་རྒྱུད་, which likely corresponds to a Sanskrit term such as Garuḍa-related imagery or a flight-metaphor epithet, but without access to the Sanskrit title the precise reconstruction remains uncertain.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.